

Richa Ghosh finally checking all the right boxes

On the brink of turning 21, Richa is already one of India's trump cards ahead of the Women's T20 World Cup in the United Arab Emirates — evidence of her **immense talent** and meteoric rise.

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During the Senior Women's Inter Zonal Multi-Day Trophy final in April this year, a spirited South Zone side, featuring players such as Sajeevan Sajana, Minnu Mani, and Arundhati Reddy, threatened to ruin what had been a fairly smooth run for the Deepti Sharma-led East Zone.

If you were standing by the East Zone tent, amidst all the cheers, one chant stood out: "*Haan, Richa aur Deepti hai. Maar lenge*" (Richa and Deepti will see it through). These words served as fuel for the young Richa Ghosh, just four years into her international career. Known for her explosive batting, she's feared and admired equally.

"This is something I've been experiencing a lot lately," Richa says, reflecting on the thrilling final that East Zone eventually won.

"I think hearing those cheers at the domestic level helped me a lot. Knowing that a bunch of people have so much trust in me, saying, '*Richa hai toh ho jayega*' (If Richa is there, it'll happen), is incredible. It makes you

want to prove them right. There are people who believe I can achieve something, so I have to, no matter what."

Just a month before this final, Richa played a pivotal role in an incredible turnaround for Royal Challengers Bengaluru in the Women's Premier League (WPL). During the second leg of the tournament in New Delhi, RCB's campaign was hanging by a thread, with its qualification hopes relying on increasingly complex scenarios. RCB began the final week with a gut-wrenching one-run loss to Delhi Capitals. The image of a devastated Richa, who was run out on the last ball, went viral on social media. She was inconsolable as Delhi's Jemimah

